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Rare show of GOP resistance to Trump

In a series of setbacks, lawmakers on Hill begin to flex their independence

BY RILEY BEGGIN,
ANNA LISS-ROY
AND JARRELL DILLARD

President Donald Trump has repeatedly bent congressional Republicans to his will, pushing his proposals through meager resistance with the threat of mobilizing the Republican base against disloyal members of his party.

This past week, GOP lawmakers in both chambers indicated that their patience with that strategy may be wearing thin.

A series of setbacks on Capitol Hill — on issues spanning the Iran war, a \$1.8 billion “anti-weaponization” fund and the proposed White House ballroom — illustrated simmering tensions between GOP lawmakers and the president ahead of what could be bruising midterms in November.

Republicans began the week with an expected win on the horizon: passage of their party-line immigration funding bill, which they planned to send to Trump’s desk before a week-long Memorial Day break.

The first challenge was clear. The bill — intended to send \$70 billion to Immigration and Customs Enforcement, U.S. Customs and Border Protection, and other law enforcement efforts — included \$1 billion in security funding for the “East Wing Modernization Project,” the name for Trump’s proposed ballroom and underground renovations.

Some Republicans were already concerned about the optics

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\$1.8 billion fund: Little oversight or public scrutiny of the payouts. **A4**

Thousands in California flee chemical threat



ABOVE: ETHAN SWOPE/AP; BELOW: ED OU/REUTERS

Authorities in Southern California work to cool a pressurized chemical storage tank and keep it from exploding after it overheated Thursday and began venting vapors. Evacuation orders were issued for 40,000 people. At right, Ace Kelley and his partner, Diane Rutan, rest at a shelter Saturday in Fountain Valley. **Story, A8**



Gunman near White House is shot dead, officials say

Secret Service officers returned fire after being targeted, agency reports

BY MAEGAN VAZQUEZ
AND CLEVE R. WOOTSON JR.

An individual is dead after allegedly exchanging gunfire with Secret Service officers just outside the White House complex early Saturday evening, the Secret Service said.

The unnamed individual fired shots at a checkpoint at 17th Street and Pennsylvania Avenue NW, which is near the Eisenhower Executive Office Building, according to the agency.

“A preliminary investigation indicates that as the individual approached, he removed a weapon from his bag and began firing at posted officers,” Secret Service chief of communications Anthony Guglielmi said in a statement. “Secret Service police officers returned fire, striking the suspect, who was transported to an area hospital, where he later died.”

A bystander was also struck in the exchange of bullets, the Secret Service said, but it is unclear whether by the suspect or shots

SEE **SHOTS** ON A14

Artists want to use a melted Lee statue to heal a wounded city

BY GREGORY S. SCHNEIDER

CHARLOTTESVILLE — After white supremacists staged a violent rally around a monument to Confederate Gen. Robert E. Lee in 2017, the city took down the statue and community organizers melted it to ensure it would never rise again. Then they faced a dilemma.

What next?
“If we simply remove the statue and move on, we have not reckoned with anything,” former Charlottesville City Council member Leah Puryear said at a gathering here in March.

The answer has been several years in the making, but a community group is wrapping up a competition to design public art from that raw bronze. The goal: fashion something unifying out of something that caused division for nearly a century.

Cities and counties around the South have wrestled with their Confederate iconography in the wake of both Charlottesville’s Unite the Right rally and the murder of George Floyd by Minneapolis police in 2020. Richmond hauled an army of bronze Confederates to a water treatment plant before loaning sever-

al to museums in California. In North Carolina, several towns shipped their monuments to a new Valor Memorial Park on private land.

But few localities have gone as far as Charlottesville, where all that remains of Lee is a pile of bronze ingots. Nearly three dozen artists and design firms submitted ideas for reusing that bronze, and the Swords into Plowshares nonprofit has winnowed the group down to three finalists.

“This is not, as some of our detractors say, an attempt to erase history, but rather to kind

of tell a fuller version of it by using the materials from the past that have caused a lot of pain,” said Jalane Schmidt, a University of Virginia religious studies professor and co-founder of Swords into Plowshares.

The group faced threats and a lawsuit over its plan to melt the nearly century-old statue of Lee, and had to carry out the job in secret in 2023 out of security concerns. But Schmidt said she is relieved they acted when they did now that President Donald Trump is leading a call to restore Confederate names and iconography in public spaces, such as a

memorial he wants erected again in Arlington National Cemetery.

The organizers are aiming for something more complex than simply another statue. They hope to capture the essence of the community and, ultimately, help heal the wounds of history — all in the shadow of Thomas Jefferson’s home at Monticello and his beloved University of Virginia, sites that embody an American legacy of freedom founded on the backs of the enslaved.

“This is an act of reclamation,” said Andrea Douglas, executive

SEE **STATUE** ON A7



DANIELLE VILLASANA/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Stevee Williams, who was diagnosed with anorexia when she was 17, began using GLP-1 drugs at age 27 ahead of her sister’s wedding.

A collision of GLP-1 use, eating disorders

Providers say they’re seeing patients with anorexia, bulimia, binge behavior

BY CHRISTOPHER ROWLAND
AND ARIANA EUNJUNG CHA

Stevee Williams, a restaurant manager in Houston, was preparing for her sister’s wedding when anxieties bubbled up about how she would look in her bridesmaid dress. She was diagnosed with anorexia when she was 17 and her struggle with eating never left.

This time, at 27, she turned to a new tool to control her appetite, one of the GLP-1 drugs fueling a national weight-loss craze. On an online site promising easy prescriptions, she typed that she was

150 pounds (she wasn’t) and indicated she did not “feel well enough to get up and move around” (which also wasn’t true). Then she entered her credit card information.

“In reality, I just wanted to be smaller,” she said. A bottle of Wegovy pills — \$149 — arrived soon after.

Stories like this are alarming doctors, psychologists and patients working on recovery who say these drugs pose a serious threat to people with eating disorders. Providers on the front lines said they are routinely encountering patients like these

taking GLP-1 drugs, some of whom have suffered a relapse and others who have developed an eating disorder for the first time while on the medications.

Heavy promotion, easy access and a lack of warning labels add to the allure for people who are obsessed with losing weight, they say.

Ozempic, Wegovy, Zepbound — and off-brand copies sold on the internet — have revolutionized the weight-loss industry because they are remarkably effective in suppressing appetite. But in addition to the better-known

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Shai Gilgeous-Alexander is basketball’s MGP: Most Glamorous Player.

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